meesho SEASON 3 DICE CHALLENGE

BUSINESS TRACK · DETAILED SUBMISSION ROUND · 8–10 SLIDE DECK + WORKING PROTOTYPE

Building Meesho's Consumer-to-Manufacturer (C2M) Base

Screen on price, not scale. Pay for early conviction in impressions, not rupees. Make nothing until it is sold.

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Live prototype meesho-dice-c2m-iitb.vercel.app

Scan to open

WHO, AND WHY NOT

Q1 · Manufacturer segmentation · Which cohorts do we go after first, and what stops each of them?

₹41,560 cr
FY26 NMV, +39% YoY

₹265
FY26 AOV, down 3% YoY

4.0%
Contribution margin, Q4 FY26 exit (2.3% in Q3)

9.6 lakh
Transacting sellers, +87% YoY

0%
Commission, now matched: Flipkart fashion at every price (8 Jul 2026)

264 mn
Annual transacting users, +33%

COHORT A · Offline-only, B2B bulk

72% of 11,645 ≈ **8,400 firms**

PROFILE
Made to order, distributor-fed, zero returns, 45–60 day terms

BARRIER
No unit-level ops; build-to-stock is a balance-sheet change

MOTIVATION
Idle capacity; export shock (US tariff 50%, Aug–Dec 2025)

LEVER
Factory Node + demand-confirmed batches

REACH
Cluster associations (e.g., Tiruppur Exporters' Association), 40–60 factories a drive

COHORT B · Online, active elsewhere

19% of 11,645 ≈ **2,200 firms**

PROFILE
On Amazon, Flipkart or own D2C; GST and catalogue done

BARRIER
₹800+ basket catalogue loses money at a ₹265 AOV

MOTIVATION
264 mn buyers and a Tier-2+ base it cannot reach elsewhere

LEVER
Price check + value-tier catalogue, not a discount

REACH
Price-check link via seller agencies and associations; no cold sales calls

COHORT C · Churned from Meesho

9% of 11,645 ≈ **1,050 firms**

PROFILE
Listed, exited inside two quarters; catalogue dormant

BARRIER
Weak first 30 orders, then an RTO or returns shock

MOTIVATION
Sunk catalogue cost; KYC and price history already exist

LEVER
Returns firewall + health-score re-entry

REACH
Meesho's own dormant-seller list; one WhatsApp re-invite, KYC already on file

BARRIER SEVERITY × COHORT

from the 24-interview objection set

Barrier	A	B	C	Meesho can fix
Unit-level fulfilment	HIGH	LOW	MED	YES
Inventory risk, build-to-stock	HIGH	MED	HIGH	YES
Returns and RTO exposure	HIGH	MED	HIGH	YES
Unproven demand	HIGH	MED	HIGH	YES
Cash cycle, settlement lag	MED	LOW	MED	PART
Channel conflict, brand dilution	HIGH	HIGH	LOW	PART

Four of six barriers are HIGH for Cohort A and all four are fixable with infrastructure. Brand dilution at a ₹265 AOV is not fixable, which is why Cohort B gets a separate value-tier catalogue rather than a discount.

FIELD EVIDENCE · TIRUPPUR, THE PILOT CLUSTER

3,200
knitwear manufacturers

₹74,747 cr
FY26 output; ₹44,747 cr exported, ≈₹30,000 cr domestic

−60 to −70%
US orders under the 50% tariff, Aug–Dec 2025

750–1,000
units shut; tariff now 18%, plus an India–EU trade deal

So what: the export shock proved the motivation, and the rollback is closing the window. Pilot now, and sell C2M as a permanent hedge, not a rescue.

RESEARCH DESIGN · METHODS, COVERAGE

Method	n	Output
Manufacturer interviews, 3 cohorts	8 each	Objection set, barrier grid
Cluster walk-throughs	2	Cost Ownership Index
Platform teardown: fees, feed, panel	4 cats	Landed-price medians
Filings, earnings calls, Udyam, cluster studies	15+	FY26 baseline, addressable base
Global C2M teardowns	7 · 5 mkts	Copy / avoid library
Round 2 fact-check: results, earnings call, Reuters, trade press	20+	Corrected margin, precedents
Prototype simulation (synthetic, seeded)	261 · 4,415 SKUs	Rules tested end to end

DELIBERATELY NOT NOW

Fashion-led ethnic wear, Surat
India's largest textile cluster (₹1 lakh cr+) ranks last on our cluster AHP (3.28): traders job out weaving, dyeing and stitching, and it sits in the worst return band.

Electronics accessories, import-assembly
No cost ownership, so any price gap has to be funded, and a funded gap is a subsidy with a different name.

Sources: Meesho FY26 results and Q4 FY26 earnings call (6 May 2026); Flipkart newsroom (8 Jul 2026); Udyam Registration Portal; The Federal, Deccan Herald (Tiruppur, 2025–26); team interviews (n = 24). Cohort shares of the 11,645 addressable base.

Start with Cohort A in Tiruppur and Panipat: its barriers are operational, and operational barriers are the only ones Meesho can remove with infrastructure instead of subsidy.

HOW BIG, HOW CHEAP

Q2 · Market sizing and opportunity · How big is the base, and what does closing the price gap do for buyers and NMV?

ADDRESSABLE BASE · BOTTOM-UP

4.72 cr	Udyam-registered MSMEs, 98.9% micro	
5.28 lakh	above micro (small + medium)	1.1%
1.85 lakh	in manufacturing	35%
55,451	making Meesho's categories	30%
19,408	own ≥ 3 of 4 cost levers (COI)	35%
11,645	inside the 12 screened clusters	60%
1,400	active C2M sellers by Year 4	12%

Right-hand figure = conversion from the row above. COI = Cost Ownership Index: raw material, production, scale, automation.

OPPORTUNITY LADDER · PRICE AND NMV IMPACT

	Pilot · Day 90	Scale · Q2+	Target · Year 4
Clusters · Factory Nodes	2 · 1	5 · 6	12 · 12
Active C2M sellers	60	450	1,400
Run-rate NMV	**₹86 cr**	**₹641 cr**	**₹1,995 cr**
Share of FY26 NMV	0.2%	1.5%	4.8%
Buyer savings / yr, gap 8–12%	**₹7.4–₹12 cr**	**₹56–₹87 cr**	**₹173–₹272 cr**
Contribution at 4.0% CM	₹3.4 cr	₹26 cr	₹80 cr

Buyer savings = NMV × g ÷ (1 − g) · g from the 8% gate floor to 12%, the low end of the 12–18% cost edge integration buys. Contribution uses the 4.0% Q4 FY26 exit rate.

4.8%
of FY26 NMV becomes structurally cheaper

₹173–272
₹ cr a year returned to buyers

₹80 cr
contribution a year at today's margin

WHY NOW · THE RATE-CARD MOAT IS GONE

Apr 2025	Nov 2025	Nov 2025	Mar 2026	8 Jul 2026
Amazon: no referral fee < ₹300	Flipkart: 0% < ₹1,000; Shopsy 0%	Amazon: 0% referral < ₹1,000	Amazon expands zero fees	Flipkart: 0% on all fashion, any price

Fees converge to zero. The only price advantage a competitor's rate card cannot copy is a cost-structure advantage.

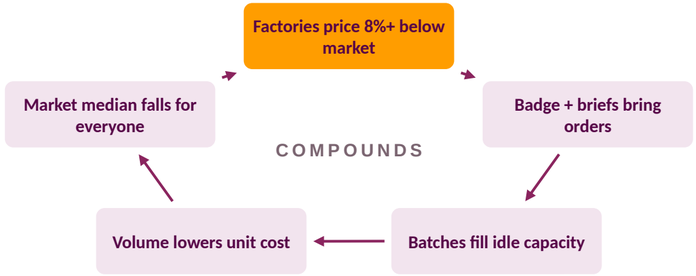
WHERE TO PILOT · CLUSTER AHP

Cluster	Cost	Dem	Ret	Node	Inst	Score
Tiruppur	5	5	4	4	5	4.68
Panipat	5	4	5	4	4	4.52
Ludhiana	4	3	4	4	4	3.74
Rajkot	4	3	5	3	3	3.70
Surat	2	5	2	5	3	3.28

Criteria: cost ownership, demand on Meesho, returns band, node feasibility, institutional partner (association).

Surat passes a scale screen and fails the price screen. Pilot where cost ownership, low returns and an association to recruit through coincide: Tiruppur (hosiery) and Panipat (home textiles).

10X · THE C2M FLYWHEEL



Every lap lowers the median resellers are measured against. The price edge compounds instead of being paid for.

Sources: Udyam Registration Portal (team pull; 7.83 cr incl. Udyam Assist, PIB Feb 2026); Meesho FY26 results; Flipkart, Amazon, Business Standard, Outlook Business (2025–26); Round 1 cluster AHP and teardown. Run-rate NMV assumes the Round 1 Year-4 yield of ₹1.43 cr per seller.

11,645 manufacturers in 12 clusters can carry a real price gap. Capturing 12% by Year 4 adds ₹1,995 cr of NMV priced at least 8% below today's market: ₹173 cr to ₹272 cr a year back to buyers.

WHERE PRICE IS REAL

Q3 · Which manufacturers and categories carry a genuine, defensible price advantage, and which do not despite scale?

CATEGORY SCREEN · 12 SCREENED, 9 IN SCOPE

Category	Cluster	Floor	Idle	Ret.	Frt.
Unstitched saree & dress material	Erode, Bhiwandi	✓	✓	✓	✓
Home textiles: sheets, towels	Panipat, Solapur	✓	✓	✓	–
Hosiery, innerwear, socks	Tiruppur, Ludhiana	✓	–	✓	✓
Moulded plastic housewares	Rajkot, Daman	✓	✓	✓	–
Imitation jewellery	Rajkot, Coimbatore	✓	✓	–	✓
Steel kitchenware, utensils	Jagadhri, Wazirpur	✓	–	✓	–
Basic footwear, PU/EVA	Agra, Bahadurgarh	✓	✓	–	✓
Brass décor & lighting	Moradabad	✓	×	✓	–
Bags, school bags	Nangloi, Kolkata	–	✓	–	✓
Ethnic wear	Surat (largest)	×	✓	×	✓
Fitted western, jeans	Gandhi Nagar, Bengaluru	–	✓	×	✓
Electronics accessories	import-assembly	×	✓	–	✓

Floor = cost floor below the market median · Idle = spare capacity · Ret. = low return band · Frt. = freight per rupee of value. Rows 10–12 fail two tests: not now.

PRICE TRUTH INDEX · THE SCREEN

Comparable-set median

Order-weighted landed price on delivered orders, per product type. SKUs need ≥ 10 orders.

SKU price gap

gap = (median − seller landed price) ÷ median

Dominant-seller fix

A seller with > 30% of a set's orders is scored against the median without its own orders.

Catalogue gate

≥ 8% gap on ≥ 60% of live SKUs, sellers above ₹5 cr GMV. One loss-leader cannot buy the badge.

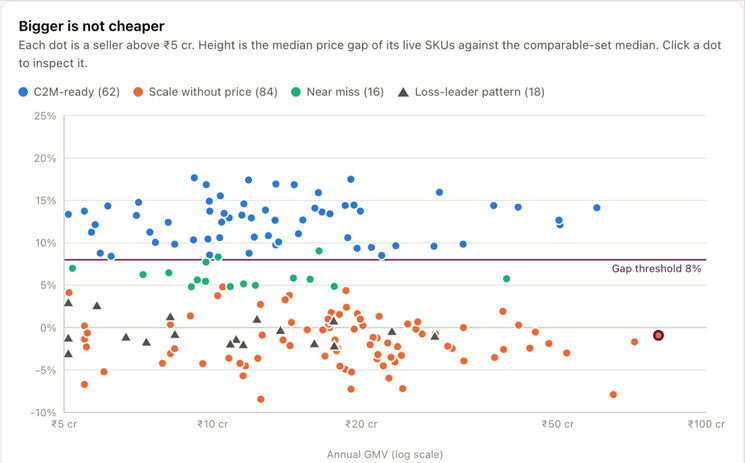
Badge + re-rank, with a holdout

Matched control, read at Day 30 (see Roadmap).

Worked example

SKU landed at ₹212 vs a ₹245 median → gap 13.5% ✓. Catalogue: 18 of 24 live SKUs clear = 75% ≥ 60% → badge. A seller with 3 SKUs at −30% and 21 at market clears 13% → no badge.

BIGGER IS NOT CHEAPER · FROM THE WORKING PROTOTYPE



Correlation between seller size and price gap is -0.18: among large sellers, more GMV does not mean a lower shelf price. 7 of the 10 largest sellers fail the gate.

180	62 · 34%	84 · 47%	r = -0.18
sellers above ₹5 cr screened	pass the gate	scale without price	size vs price gap

The six largest sellers screened (prototype, fictional names)

Seller	GMV	Median gap	Verdict
Moti Sarees · Indore	₹80 cr	-0.9%	Scale without price
Surya Distributors · Delhi	₹72 cr	-1.7%	Scale without price
Prem Footwear · Ahmedabad	₹65 cr	-7.9%	Scale without price
Bharat Shoe Co. · Bahadurgarh	₹60 cr	14.1%	C2M-ready
Neel Travel Gear · Surat	₹52 cr	-3.0%	Scale without price
Annapurna Knitwear · Ludhiana	₹51 cr	12.1%	C2M-ready

7 of the 10 largest fail: they are traders, and scale never became price.

WHY CATEGORY BEATS SCALE · THE RETURN MATH

Return cost per unit kept	at ₹90 / return	at ₹150 / return
30% returns (fitted ethnic)	₹39 · 14.6% of AOV	₹64 · 24.3% of AOV
5% returns (home textiles)	₹5 · 1.8% of AOV	₹8 · 3.0% of AOV
Gap between the two categories	**13 pp of AOV**	**21 pp of AOV**

Returns × fee ÷ units kept. A wrong category swallows the whole 12–18% cost edge before a buyer sees it. ₹90 is our estimate; ₹150 is the seller-guide rate for ≤ 500 g.

FOUR VERDICTS, FOUR ACTIONS

Verdict	Action
C2M-ready (62)	Badge + re-rank + Demand Brief
Scale without price (84)	No badge; offer a value-tier catalogue
Loss-leader pattern (18)	No badge; the catalogue gate holds
Near miss (16)	Factory Node cost help; re-score in 28 days

Sources: Round 1 segment scorecard and platform teardown; seller-guide return fees (Shiprocket, Robnu, 2026). Prototype figures come from synthetic, seeded data (fictional sellers) and demonstrate the method, not Meesho's actual distribution.

Screen on price, not size: badge a catalogue only when ≥ 60% of its live SKUs sit ≥ 8% below the comparable-set median. In the prototype, 7 of the 10 largest sellers fail that test.

GETTING THEM ON

Q4 · Onboarding model · Support stack, risk-sharing and assisted operations for reluctant manufacturers

THE MADE-TO-MEESHO FLOW · ONE MANUFACTURER, END TO END

numbers from the working prototype

1 · Price check
Lowest price at 9% margin ₹213 vs ₹245 median: 13.3% below, qualifies before listing

2 · Demand Brief
12 districts, 15,630 orders a week, price band and size mix; first batch 1,900 units

3 · Batch window
Buyers pre-order (ships in 7 days); 1,052 confirmed, make 1,210 (+15% buffer)

4 · Bulk handover
One drop at the cluster Factory Node; 30% of confirmed value, ₹67,223, paid at handover

5 · Node runs unit ops
Pick, pack, ship each order; returns terminate at the node, not the factory

6 · Settlement
Balance 7 days after delivery: cash in ~11 days vs 50 on distributor terms

EVERY BARRIER HAS A LEVER · COVERAGE

Barrier	Price check	Demand Brief	Batch window	Factory Node	Returns firewall	Prepay
Unit-level fulfilment				✓		
Inventory risk		–	✓			–
Returns and RTO	–			✓	✓	
Unproven demand		✓	✓			
Cash cycle				–		✓
Channel conflict	✓	–				

✓ removes · – reduces. The price check prices returns in; the node cuts reverse cost; the firewall caps the rest.

SUPPORT STACK BY COHORT

A — Offline B2B
Cluster co-op onboarding (40–60 at a time) · price check · briefs · batch window · Factory Node · 30% prepayment

B — Online elsewhere
Price check → separate value-tier SKUs (not a discount) · briefs · may self-ship

C — Churned
Returns firewall (capped exposure) · health-score re-entry · catalogue and KYC reused

PRECEDENT · WHAT WE COPY, WHAT WE AVOID

Platform	Mechanic	Result
Copy · Pinduoduo	Anonymised demand data to factories (New Brand Initiative)	900+ factories, 2,200+ custom SKUs, 115 mn orders by end-2019
Copy · Temu	Semi-managed: bulk to local warehouses, platform runs storefront	Targeted 60–80% of US GMV in 2025
Avoid · Shein Brazil	Demanded ~30% price cuts and faster delivery from factories	336 signed vs 2,000 target; 1 still producing (Reuters, Feb 2026)

Lesson: fix the operating model and measure the gap that already exists. Never ask a factory for a price cut.

ASSISTED OPERATIONS · WHAT THE FACTORY NODE BUYS (₹98 COST, 9% MARGIN)

	Lowest viable price	Below market median	Return cost / unit kept	Margin at ₹221	C2M badge
Ship each order yourself	₹219	10.8%	₹8	10.0%	✓ yes
Factory Node	**₹213**	**13.3%**	**₹6**	**12.5%**	✓ yes

Working capital: 2.5% of revenue on 50-day distributor terms vs 0.6% on a prepaid batch (18% cost of capital). Node rates are proposal assumptions (src/config.js).

RISK-SHARING · WHO CARRIES WHAT

Risk	B2B today	Made-to-Meesho
Unsold stock	None: made to order	**Only the 15% buffer on confirmed orders**
Returns handling	None	**Node absorbs it; firewall pool caps the loss**
Waiting for cash	45–60 days	**30% at handover; rest ~7 days after delivery**
Demand	Distributor orders	**Pre-orders plus the pin-code brief**

Sources: prototype manufacturer app (illustrative seller Kavin Knit Mills, fictional; ₹98 making cost; assumptions in src/config.js); Reuters via FashionNetwork (Feb 2026); KrASIA (Pinduoduo, 2019 data); Tech Buzz China (Temu, 2025).

Keep the B2B risk model: price-check before listing, show demand by pin-code, make only what is pre-ordered, and hand over in bulk to a Factory Node that runs unit operations.

KEEPING THEM

Q5 · Sustainable scale-up · Early order conviction and retention, without subsidy or handholding

THE COLD-START GAP, IN MEESHO'S OWN WORDS

"If their quality is not that great, they do not get visibility for orders. And products that have very good quality continue to scale on the platform."

— Vidit Aatrey, CEO, Q4 FY26 earnings call, 6 May 2026

Implication: a new factory needs orders to prove quality and quality to earn orders. That loop, not price, is why new sellers take a small share of orders in their first 30 days.

IMPRESSIONS, NOT RUPEES · THE GRANT

12
Demand Brief pin-codes get starter impressions

+25K
impressions for 7 days if orders < 60% at D7/D14

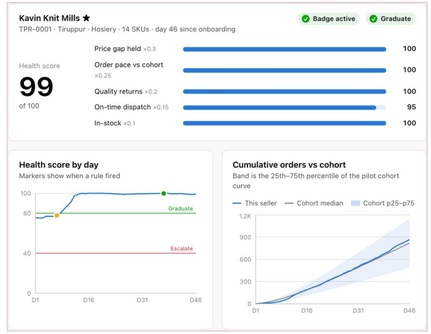
max 2
grants per seller

≤ 20%
of category impressions, hard cap

CONVICTION, THEN RETENTION · WHAT FIRES, WHEN, AND WHAT WE WATCH

Stage	When	What Meesho does, automatically	Trigger	Seller sees	KPI
Qualify	Day 0	Badge on; re-rank inside the category	Passed the price gate	C2M badge	Gap at onboarding
Allocate	D0–D14	Starter impressions in the 12 Demand Brief pin-codes	Onboarding	First orders where demand is	Orders vs cohort curve
Allocate	D7, D14	+25K impressions for 7 days (max 2 grants)	Orders < 60% of cohort median	WhatsApp: grant applied	Recovery by D21
Diagnose	Daily	Health Score from five signals (see Metrics)	Every day	Weekly score card	Score 0–100
Remedy	On trigger	Price nudge · QC hold · node offer · restock nudge	8 rule thresholds	One specific fix	Time to recover
Graduate	D30+	Batch prepayment unlocked	Score ≥ 80 for 30 days	Cheaper working capital	Graduation rate
Retain	D60+	Weekly brief refresh; prepaid batches each cycle; Meesho Mall path	Graduated, gap held	Steady demand, fast cash	Active at D90
Human	Exception	Category manager reviews	Score < 40 for 7 days after a fix	A call	≤ 5 per 100 / month

ONE SELLER · KAVIN KNIT MILLS (FICTIONAL), TIRUPPUR



Day 0
Badge on; first batch handed over at the node
Day 7
Orders at D7 were 41% of the cohort median (floor 60%): a grant fires, no one calls
Day 8+
Orders recover into the cohort band; score ≥ 80
Day 37
Graduated: batch prepayment unlocked

SCALES TO HUNDREDS WITHOUT HEADCOUNT

90 : 3
automated vs human actions

~910
sellers per category manager

Sellers per manager = capacity ÷ escalation rate = 40 ÷ (3 ÷ 68 seller-months) ≈ 910. The 3 escalations are the only human touches in the pilot.

At 1,400 sellers	People	What they do
Account managers (1 per ~20)	~70	Chase every seller, every week
Rules + exceptions	~2	Review only failed fixes

EXPLICITLY REJECTED

Option	Why not
Order subsidy or paid boosts	Buys volume, not conviction; stops the day funding stops
Account managers per seller	Works at 20 sellers, breaks at 200, cannot reach 1,400
Onboarding by turnover	The brief's own diagnosis: scale is not price
Weakening the quality gate	Protects nobody; grants target traffic, not ranking rules

Sources: Meesho Q4 FY26 earnings call transcript (6 May 2026); prototype Seller Health module (synthetic 60-seller pilot, fixed seed). The category-manager capacity of 40 escalation reviews a month is an assumption.

Pay for early conviction in impressions, not rupees, and let rules fix what the Health Score flags: 90 automated actions to 3 escalations, ~910 sellers per category manager.

WHAT WE WATCH

Q6 · Metrics and KPIs · What Meesho tracks across onboarding, activation and retention, and when it steps in

KPI TREE · ONBOARDING → ACTIVATION → RETENTION

NORTH STAR · PRICE-COMPETITIVE C2M NMV
NMV from sellers whose catalogue still clears the ≥ 8% gate

ONBOARDING

Qualified → listed
≥ 50% in 30 days · weekly · Category

Days to first live listing
≤ 7 · weekly · Supplier product

First batch committed
≤ 14 days · weekly · Category

ACTIVATION

Orders at D7 / D14
≥ 60% of cohort median · daily · DS

First-30-day orders
≥ cohort p50 for 70% · weekly · Growth

Days to 10th order
≤ 10 · weekly · Growth

RETENTION

Active at D90
≥ 75% · monthly · Category

Gate retention D14 / D30
≥ 70% still clear · weekly · Pricing

Graduated by D60
≥ 40% · monthly · Finance

GUARDRAILS (programme level)
Category NMV ≥ pre-period · badged ≤ 20% of category impressions · quality returns ≤ 1.5× norm · escalations ≤ 5 per 100 sellers a month

C2M SELLER HEALTH SCORE · 0–100, DAILY

30%	25%	20%	15%	10%

- **Price gap held** today's gap ÷ gap at onboarding
- **Order pace** 14-day orders ÷ cohort median (0.3 → 0, 1.0 → 100)
- **Quality returns** ≤ 1× category norm = 100, 2× = 0
- **On-time dispatch** 7-day SLA: 80% → 0, 97% → 100
- **In-stock** live SKUs in stock: 50% → 0, 95% → 100

≥ 80 for 30 days
Graduate: prepayment unlocked

< 40 for 7 days after a fix
Escalate to a category manager

WHEN TO INTERVENE · THE RULEBOOK (9 AUTOMATIC, 1 HUMAN)

Signal and threshold	Action	Signal and threshold	Action
Orders < 60% of cohort median at D7 / D14	Impression grant (+25K, 7 days, max 2)	On-time dispatch < 90% over 7 days	Offer Factory Node operations
Price gap < 8% for 7 days	Price-drift nudge with market median	In-stock < 70% for 3 days	Restock nudge sized by the Demand Brief
Price gap < 4% for 3 days	Badge removed; re-entry after 7 days ≥ 8%	Score ≥ 80 for 30 days	Graduate: batch prepayment
Quality returns > 1.5× norm (≥ 30 deliveries)	Badge suspended + QC checklist	Score < 40 for 7 days after a fix	Human: category manager

LIVE IN THE PROTOTYPE · 60 PILOT SELLERS TODAY

Allocate	Diagnose	Remedy	Graduate
6	17	12	25

Average score 90 · 90 automated actions and 3 escalations so far. Remedy (amber) means an automatic fix is running; 3 of those sellers are with a person.

Daily
rules run, grants fire

Weekly
KPI review: Category, Growth

Monthly
recalibrate weights and thresholds

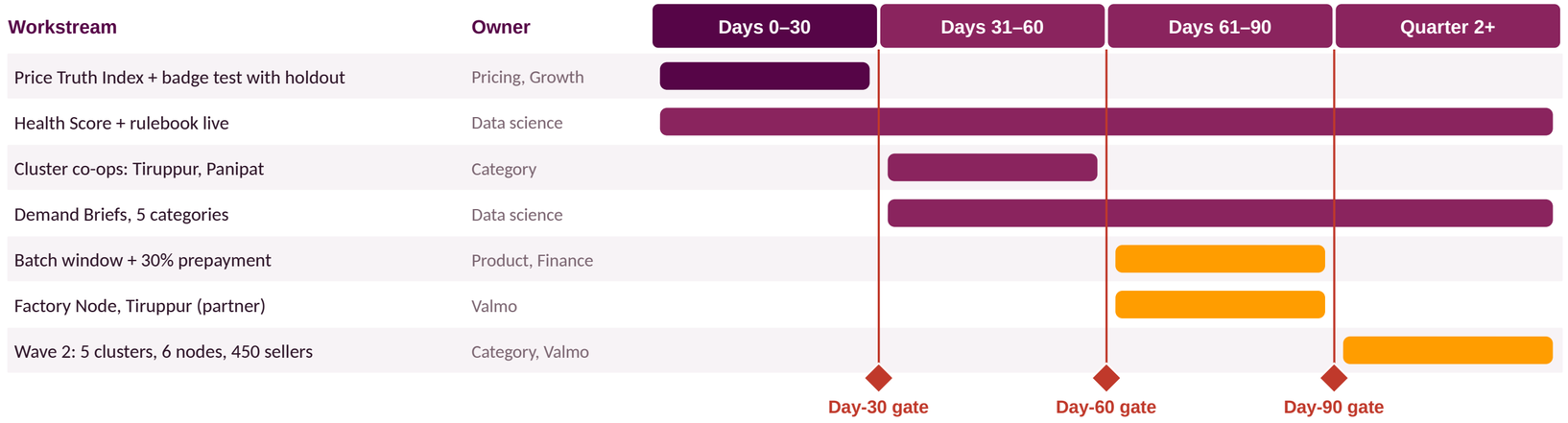
Targets are proposed pilot thresholds, to be recalibrated on the first cohort. Health Score weights and rule thresholds are the ones running in the prototype (src/config.js).

Measure the funnel from qualified to graduated, score every seller daily, and act at fixed thresholds; a person steps in only after an automatic fix has failed.

WHEN AND HOW MUCH

Q7 · 30-60-90 roadmap · What happens first, in what order, which numbers release the money, and what it costs

30-60-90 PILOT, THEN SCALE · WORKSTREAMS, OWNERS, GATES



WHERE, IN WHAT ORDER · CLUSTER WAVES

Wave	When	Clusters and categories	Sellers
Wave 1 · pilot	D0–90	Tiruppur (hosiery), Panipat (home textiles)	**60**
Wave 2 · scale	Q2–Q4	+ Ludhiana (hosiery), Rajkot (plastics, jewellery), Erode (dress material)	**450**
Wave 3 · national	Y2–Y4	+ 7 more screened clusters, all 9 categories	**1,400**

Order follows the cluster AHP (cost ownership, demand, returns band, node feasibility, an association to recruit through). Surat stays out.

Each wave opens only when the previous wave's Day-90 numbers hold.

WHAT RELEASES THE MONEY · GATES

Gate	Pass when	If not
Day 30	NMV per live SKU ≥ 12% over holdout (interval > 0) and ≥ 70% of badged sellers still clear at D14	Lift < 12%: tighten to a 10% gap and re-run. Decay: stop
Day 60	2 associations signed · 60 factories catalogued · briefs live in 5 categories	Hold node spend
Day 90	3 of 4: batches in SLA · returns end at the node · retention ≥ 70% · category NMV ≥ baseline	Fix before Wave 2

Statistical power: 62 sellers × 28 days → standard error ≈ 1.6 pts; minimum detectable lift ≈ 4.5% at 80% power, well under the 12% bar.

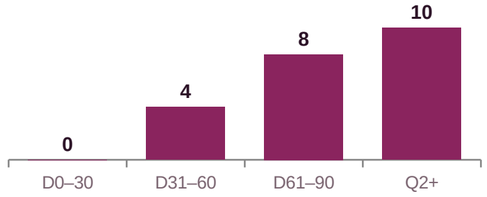
Prototype check: base +18.2% → fund · weak +4.7% → tighten · decay 40% retained → stop.

PRIORITISATION · RICE ACROSS ACQUISITION AND SCALE-UP

#	Lever	Stage	R	I	C	E	Score	Yr-1
1	**Price gate + C2M badge**	Acq	100%	2	90%	2	**0.900**	₹0
2	**Health Score + triggers**	Scale	100%	2	85%	3	**0.567**	₹0
3	Cluster co-op onboarding	Acq	90%	2	85%	3	**0.510**	₹5 cr
4	Pin-code Demand Brief	Scale	100%	2	75%	4	**0.375**	₹6 cr
5	Demand-confirmed batches	Scale	85%	3	70%	5	**0.357**	in brief
6	Factory Node (assisted ops)	Acq	100%	3	80%	8	**0.300**	₹8 cr
7	Batch prepayment	Scale	75%	2	70%	4	**0.262**	float
8	Returns firewall pool	Acq	70%	3	65%	6	**0.227**	₹3 cr

RICE = Reach × Impact × Confidence ÷ Effort (Round 1). Reach = share of the 11,645 base; Impact 1–3; Effort in engineering + ops weeks, 8 = physical infrastructure. Diagnostic and free first, capital last.

MONEY · ₹ CR



+₹156 cr
NPV at 12% (Round 1)

Year 3
breakeven

₹0 capex until the gap is proven; ₹22 cr in Year 1.
No new team: existing owners run each stream.
MSME-TEAM (₹277 cr scheme) could co-fund onboarding.

Sources: Round 1 RICE scoring, costing and NPV model (12% discount rate) and cluster AHP; prototype Day-30 readout (synthetic, 400-draw bootstrap). MSME-TEAM: Ministry of MSME / ONDC, ₹277 cr over three years (Inc42); eligibility to be confirmed.

Spend nothing until the price gap is proven: ₹0 capex to Day 30, ₹12 cr by Day 90 only if the gate says fund, and ₹22 cr in Year 1 for NPV +₹156 cr.

WHAT BREAKS, WHAT'S NEXT

Q8 · Risks and guardrails · What could go wrong, which rules keep it compliant, and where C2M takes Meesho next

RISK REGISTER · LIKELIHOOD, IMPACT, EARLY SIGNAL, GUARDRAIL

#	Risk	L	I	Early signal	Guardrail	Owner
1	**The price gap was a promotion**	H	H	Gate retention < 70% at D14	Day-30 stop rule; badge off at < 4% gap	Pricing
2	**Loss-leader SKUs game the badge**	M	M	2–3 SKUs 20%+ below, rest at market	Catalogue gate: ≥ 60% of live SKUs	Pricing
3	**Quality falls with price**	M	H	Quality returns > 1.5× norm	Suspend + QC; reinstate at ≤ 1.2× for 7 days	Category
4	**Re-rank starves existing resellers**	L	M	Category NMV vs pre-period	Badged ≤ 20% of category impressions	Growth
5	**Capex before demand**	L	H	Batch fill rate, node utilisation	No node before the Day-30 and Day-60 gates; partner warehouses first	Valmo
6	**Export recovery pulls factories back**	H	M	Tariff 50% → 18%; India–EU deal	Batches fill idle capacity around export runs; C2M as hedge	Category
7	**Rate-card war escalates**	H	L	Flipkart 0% on all fashion (Jul 2026)	Compete on cost structure (node, briefs), not fees	Strategy
8	**Shein-style squeeze drives factories away**	L	H	Attrition after price asks	Never ask for a price cut; the gate measures the gap that exists	Leadership

L = likelihood, I = impact. Why risk 8 matters: Shein pledged $150 mn for 2,000 Brazilian factories and asked for ~30% price cuts; 336 signed and 1 is still producing. Our screen only rewards a gap that already exists.

ASSUMPTIONS WE STILL HAVE TO VERIFY · BEFORE ANY CAPEX

Assumption	Value used	How we verify	By
Seller fee per customer return	₹90 (team estimate) to ₹150 (seller guides)	Pull from three live supplier panels	Day 7
Factory Node handling and forward cost	₹9 + ₹42 per unit (proposal)	Partner-warehouse quotes, Tiruppur	Day 45
Pre-order uptake at ₹20 off, 7-day delivery	55–70% of the suggested batch	A/B test in brief pin-codes	Day 60
Order lift while a grant is active	1.35× (simulation)	Holdout on the grant rule	Day 30

COMPLIANCE BY DESIGN · MARKETPLACE, CONSUMER, DATA, TAX

Rule	What it requires	Our design
FDI Press Note 2 (2018)	Marketplace may not own or control seller inventory	Seller keeps title at the node; Valmo sells warehousing at arm's length
FDI Press Note 2 (2018)	Fair, non-discriminatory services; no exclusivity	Badge and grants are published rules any seller can meet; batches fit around B2B work
E-Commerce Rules, 2026 amendment	From 1 Jan 2027: ranking parameters by importance; sponsored listings labelled	Publish the price-gap badge as a ranking parameter; grants are organic, never sold
Dark-pattern guidelines (2023)	No false urgency or hidden terms; yearly self-audit	"Ships in 7 days, ₹20 off" shown before the buyer pays
DPDP Act (2023)	Protect personal data	Demand Briefs use district-level aggregates only
GST	Stock held at a third-party site	Node added as the seller's additional place of business
Prepayment	Advances must not become inventory purchase or control	Advance via an NBFC partner against confirmed buyer orders

Design responses, not legal advice: Meesho legal confirms each row before the pilot starts.

THE 10X PATH · FROM PILOT TO SUPPLY ENGINE

Year 5+ — **Factory brands on Meesho Mall**
"Value brands … for a billion people" (Aatrey): graduates brand their own lines

Year 4 — **12 clusters · 1,400 sellers · ₹1,995 cr**
4.8% of FY26 NMV structurally cheaper

Year 2 — **5 clusters · 6 nodes**
Briefs and batches become the default onboarding path

Year 1 — **2 clusters · 60 → 450 sellers**
Prove the gap at ₹0 capex; gate the money

Sources: DPIIT Press Note 2 (2018) via Khaitan & Co, Lexology; Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Amendment Rules 2026 via LexOrbis (notified 9 Sep 2026, in force 1 Jan 2027); Meesho Q4 FY26 call; Reuters via FashionNetwork; Flipkart newsroom; KrASIA.

Every risk has a tripwire in the rulebook and a compliance answer built in; the long game is graduated factories becoming Meesho Mall value brands.

HOW MEESHO RUNS IT

Q9 · Operating model · How Meesho builds, staffs and defends it, and how robust the unit economics are

SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE · EXISTING DATA → FIVE ENGINES → FOUR SURFACES

DATA MEESHO ALREADY HOLDS

Catalogue
live SKUs, product type, landed price

Orders
delivered, NMV, RTO, return reason

Operations
dispatch time, in-stock

Exposure
impressions by pin-code

NEW ENGINES · BATCH + RULES

Price Truth Index
weekly · gate and badge

Demand Brief
weekly · district demand

Health Score
daily · five signals

Rulebook
event-driven · nine rules

Experiment readout
Day 30 · fund, tighten, stop

SURFACES

Search ranking + badge
capped at 20% of impressions

Supplier panel + WhatsApp
brief, batch, one-tap commit

Valmo Factory Node
bulk in, unit orders out

Category-manager queue
exceptions only

New build: four scheduled jobs and one rules engine on tables Meesho already has. No new data integration; the prototype runs all five.

TEAM AND OWNERSHIP · PROPOSED

Workstream	Owner	Pilot	Wave 2
Price Truth Index, badge, experiment	Pricing + data science	2	2
Demand Brief, Health Score, rulebook	Data science	2	3
Supplier panel + WhatsApp flows	Supplier product	1	2
Cluster partnerships	Category (1 per cluster)	2	5
Factory Node operations	Valmo + partner warehouse	1	3
Prepayment via lending partner	Finance	0.5	1
Total people		**8.5**	**16**

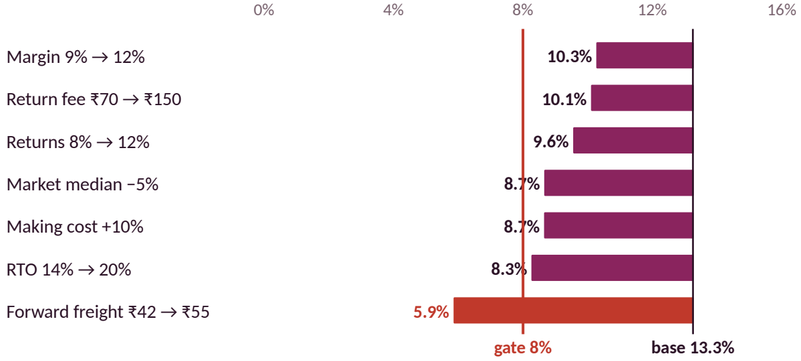
People scale with clusters, not sellers: escalations run at ~910 sellers per category manager, so 1,400 sellers need about two reviewers, not an account team.

WHY RIVALS CANNOT COPY IT QUICKLY

	Value demand ₹200–300	Tier-2+ reach	Zero fees	Bulk inbound store	Demand data to factories	Pre-order batches
Meesho + C2M	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Flipkart / Shopsy	–	✓	✓	✓	–	✕
Amazon	–	–	–	✓	–	✕
IndiaMART (B2B)	✕	–	✕	✕	✕	–
Offline distributor	–	✓	✕	✓	✕	✓

Each rival covers one or two columns. Only the full stack joins value demand to factory capacity. A rate card can be copied in a quarter; this takes years. ✓ yes · – partly · ✕ no.

STRESS TEST · KAVIN KNIT MILLS PRICE GAP



Clears the gate in 6 of 7 single-factor stresses. Freight is the thin spot, so partner-node quotes (Day 45) come before any node capex.

BUILT ON WHAT MEESHO RUNS

Valmo
handles 50–55% of deliveries; a node is one more lane

264 mn buyers
the demand signal behind every brief

Ads engine
impression inventory for grants; ad catalog +40% YoY

0% commission
no fee change needed to make C2M pay

Meesho Mall
the graduation path for factory brands

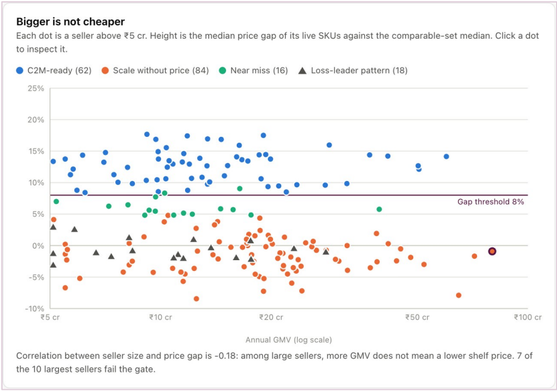
Sources: Meesho Q4 FY26 earnings call (Valmo share, ads, Meesho Mall); Flipkart and Amazon seller-fee announcements (2025–26); Tech Buzz China (Temu); prototype economics model for the stress test. Team sizes are proposals; competitor marks are team assessment from public information.

Five engines on tables Meesho already has, a pilot team of 8.5, and a stack rivals cannot copy with a rate card; Kavin still clears the 8% gate in 6 of 7 stress tests.

PROOF, LIVE

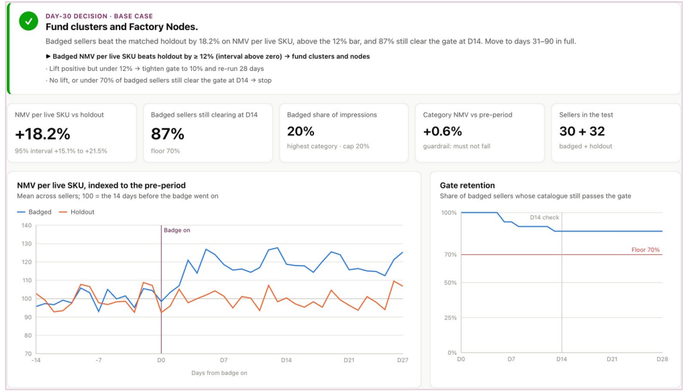
Q10 · Working prototype · Does it actually run? Every rule on this deck, live

1 · PRICE TRUTH INDEX



180 screened · 62 pass · 7 of the 10 largest fail

2 · DAY-30 READOUT



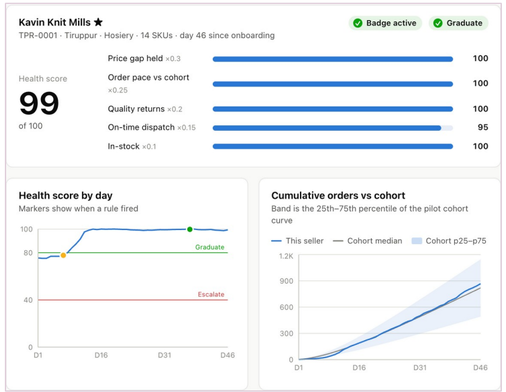
Base +18.2% (CI +15.1% to +21.5%) → fund · weak +4.7% → tighten · decay 40% retained → stop

OPEN IT

meesho-dice-c2m-iitb.vercel.app

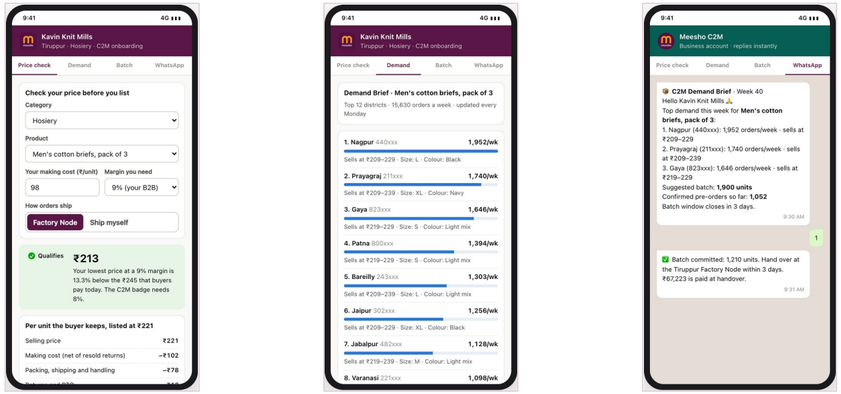
Mirror:
prathmesh-28.github.io/c2m-control-tower
Offline: one HTML file, no internet needed

3 · SELLER HEALTH



60 sellers scored daily · 90 automated : 3 human · Kavin graduates on D37

4 · MANUFACTURER APP



Price check ₹213 vs ₹245 → brief → batch of 1,210 → one-tap WhatsApp commit

HOW MEESHO WOULD RUN IT

Feed	Used for
Catalogue: SKU, product type, landed price	Median, gate, badge
Orders: delivered, NMV, RTO, return reason	Brief, experiment, quality
Operations: dispatch time, stock	Health Score, remedies
Exposure: impressions by pin-code	Grants, 20% cap

One daily batch job plus event-driven rules. No new data integration.

Built for this submission: React + Recharts, static site. 261 synthetic sellers and 4,415 SKUs across 9 categories, a 60-seller pilot, fixed seed, fictional names. Four model tests run before every deploy. All assumptions live in one config file.

The prototype runs the whole loop on synthetic data (screen, experiment, daily score, manufacturer app), and every rule in it would run unchanged on Meesho's delivered-order and listing tables.